
Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

 65,437 respondents

 180+ countries

SOURCE

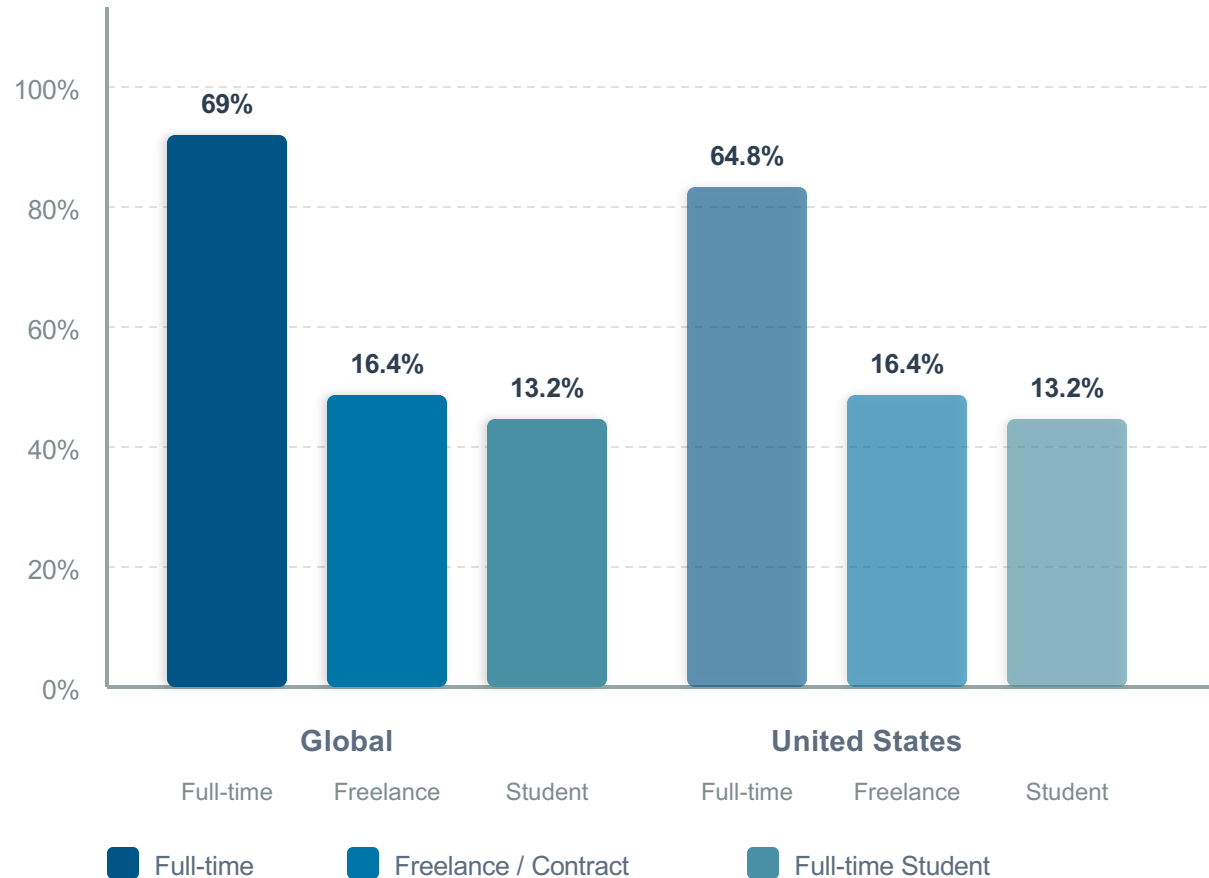
survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work



CONFIDENTIAL

KEY INSIGHT

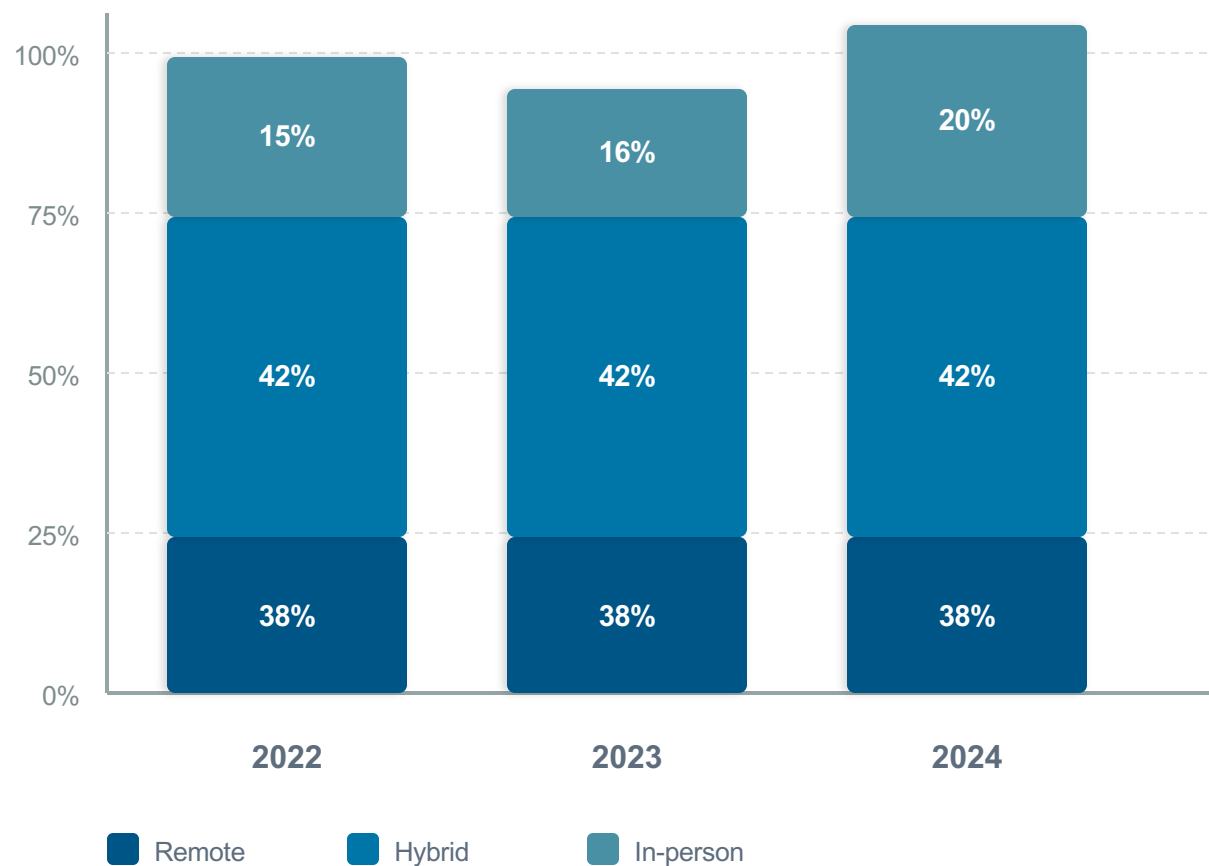
U.S. full-time employment fell from 69% to 64.8% year-over-year; freelancing remains significant at 16.4% globally.

**Key Observations**

- 84% of 65,437 respondents are currently working (full-time, part-time, or freelancing)
- U.S. full-time dropped 4.2 pp YoY: 69% → 64.8%
- U.K. & Ukraine lean toward independent contracting; Germany & India toward students
- Freelancing remains significant at 16.4%, suggesting a durable gig-economy layer

KEY INSIGHT

In-person work has risen for three consecutive years (15% → 16% → 20%), yet hybrid remains the dominant arrangement.

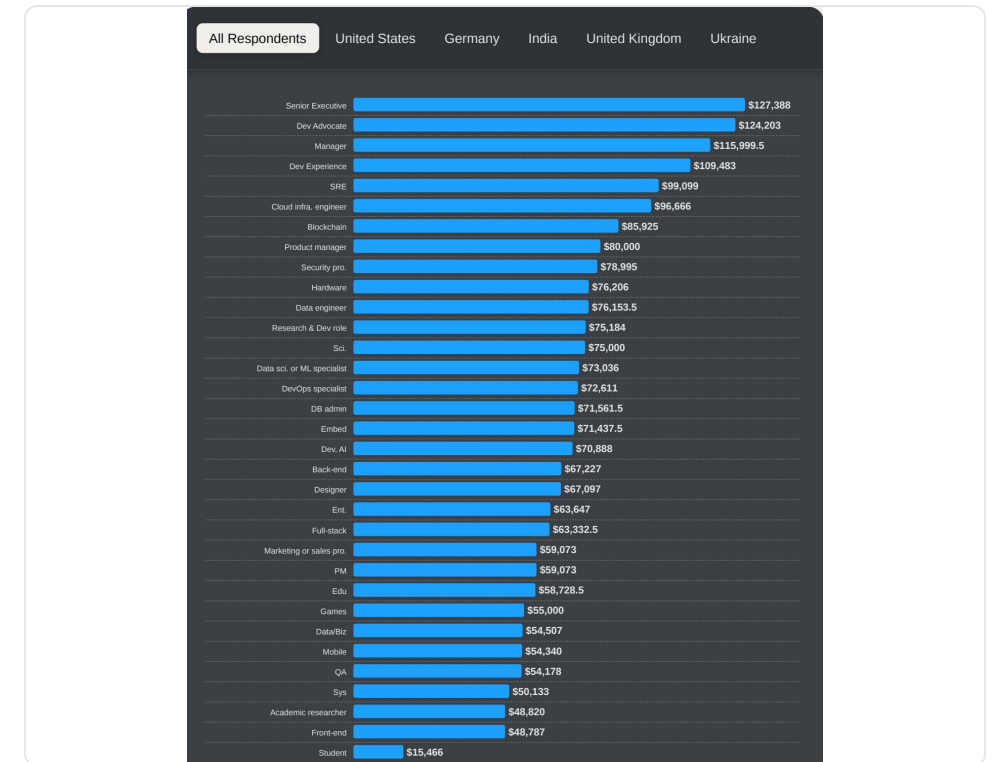
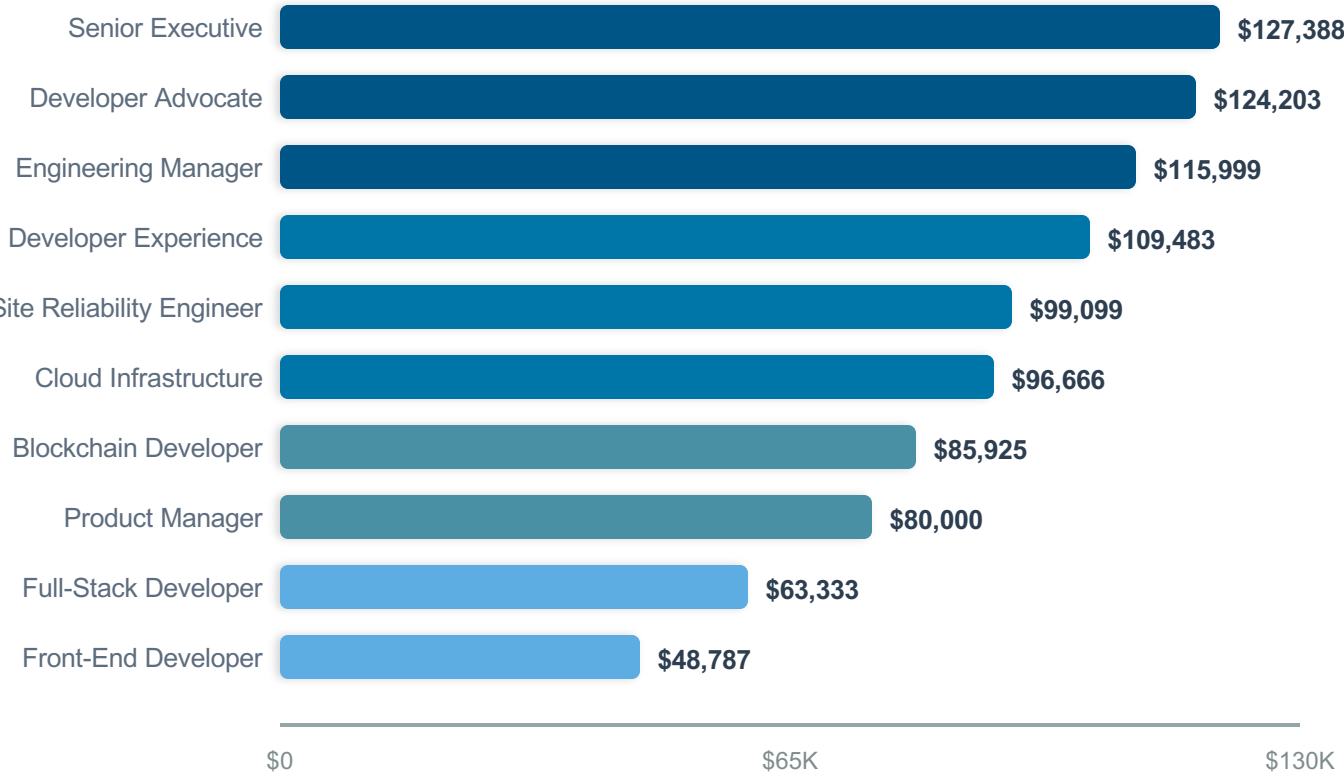


Key Observations

- Hybrid work remains the most common arrangement at 42%, unchanged from 2023
- Remote work holds steady at 38%; no significant shift away from distributed work
- In-person work has risen for three consecutive years: 15% → 16% → 20%
- Signal: gradual return-to-office, not a sudden mandate — plan for hybrid-first

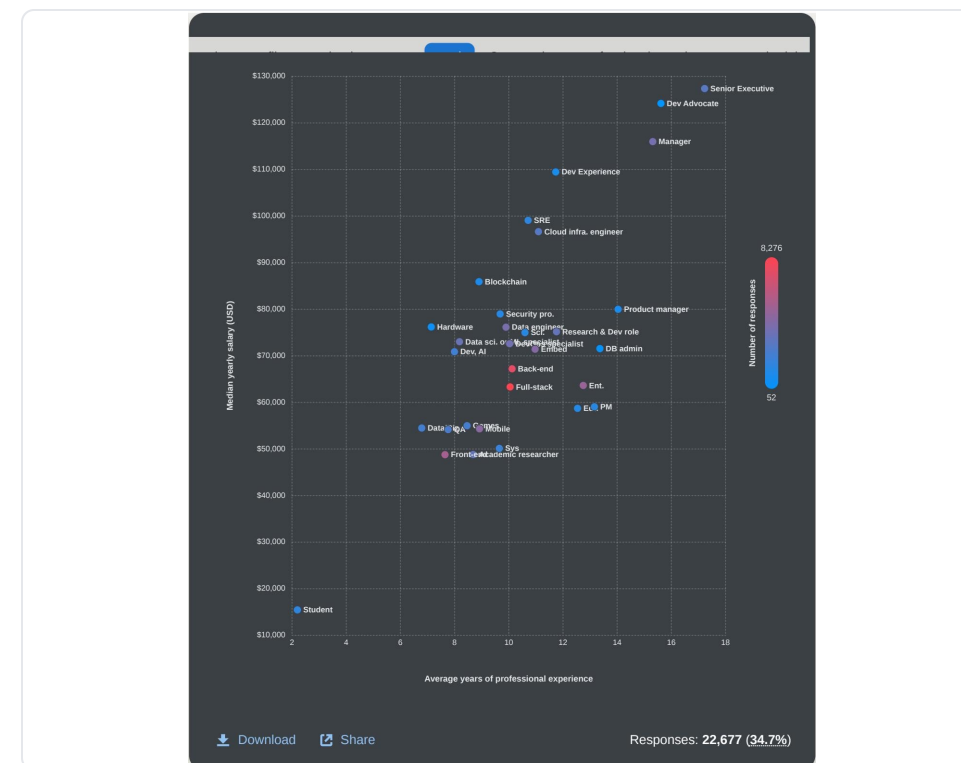
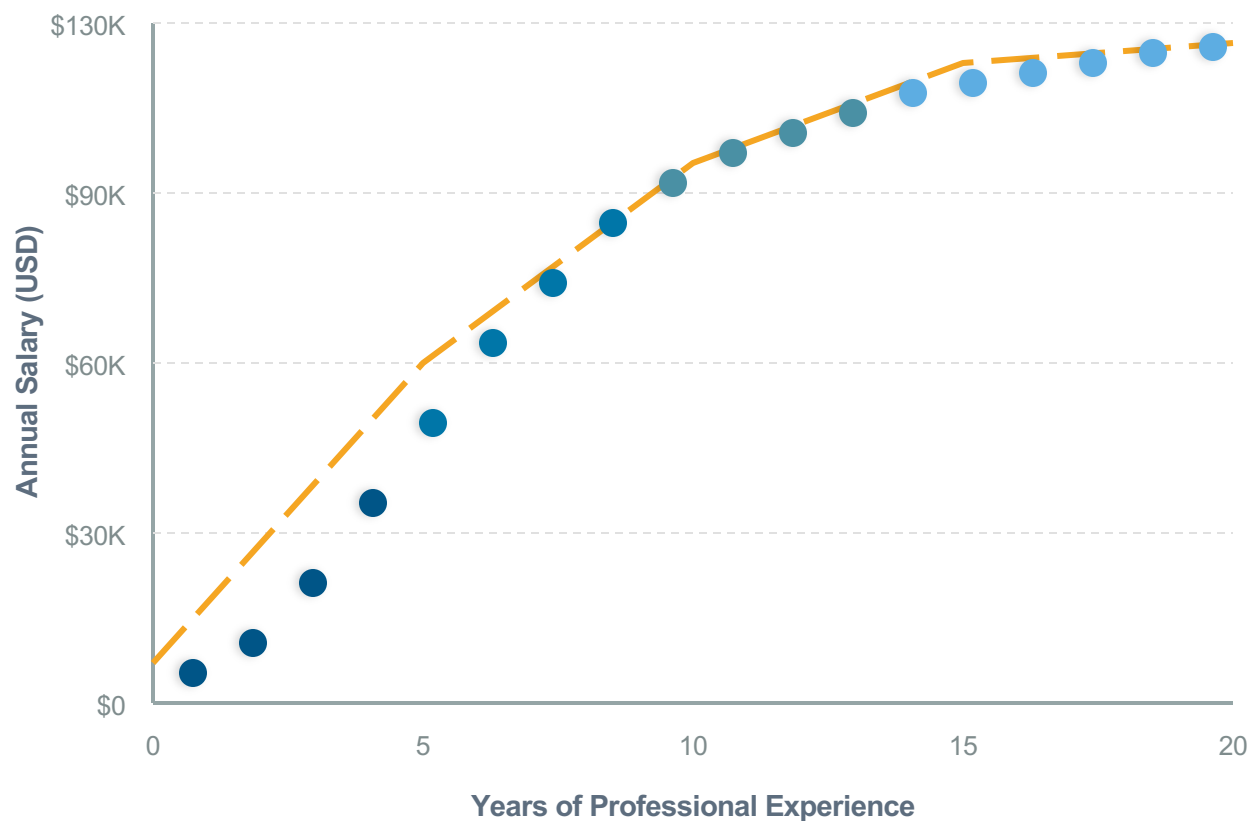
KEY INSIGHT

Senior Executive (\$127K) and Developer Advocate (\$124K) lead; Full-Stack (\$63K) and Front-End (\$49K) trail by 2.6×.



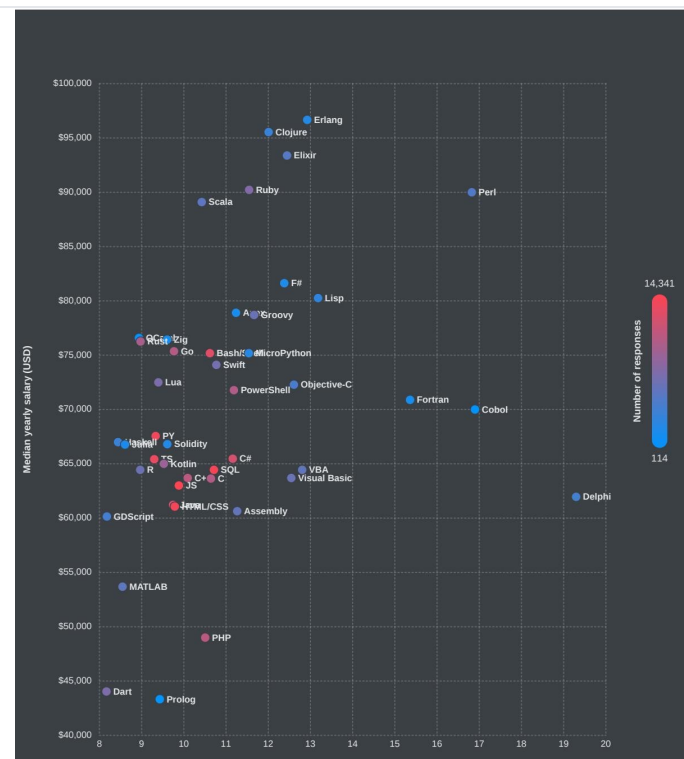
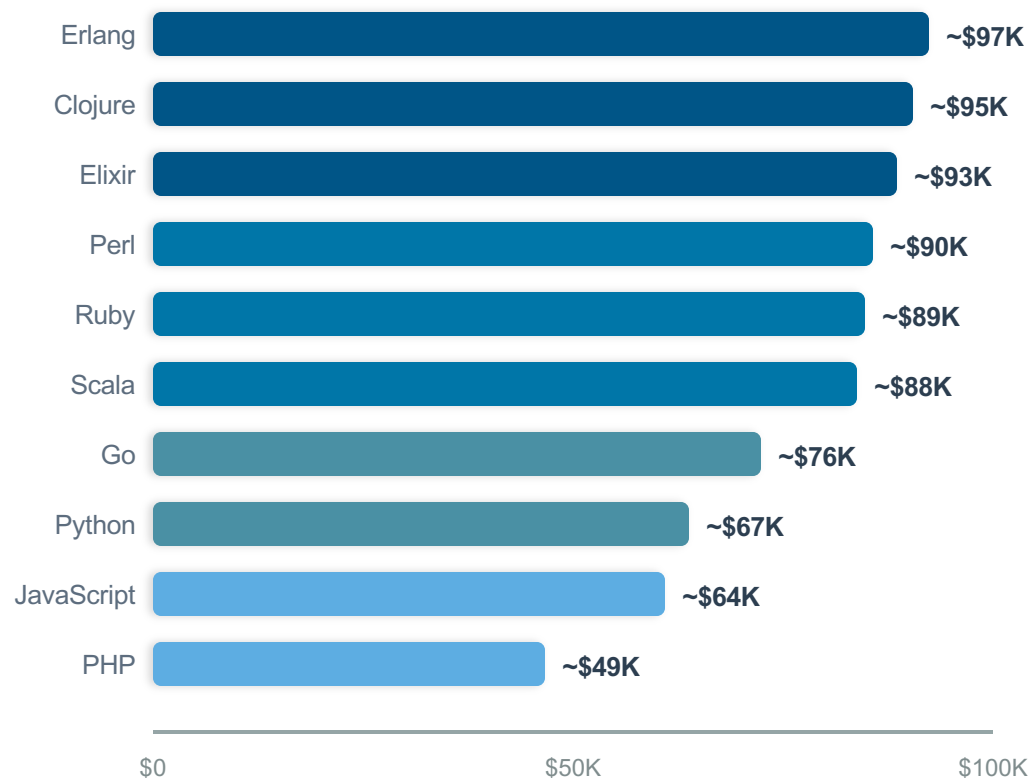
KEY INSIGHT

Compensation rises steeply from 0-10 years, then flattens; senior roles show the widest salary dispersion.



KEY INSIGHT

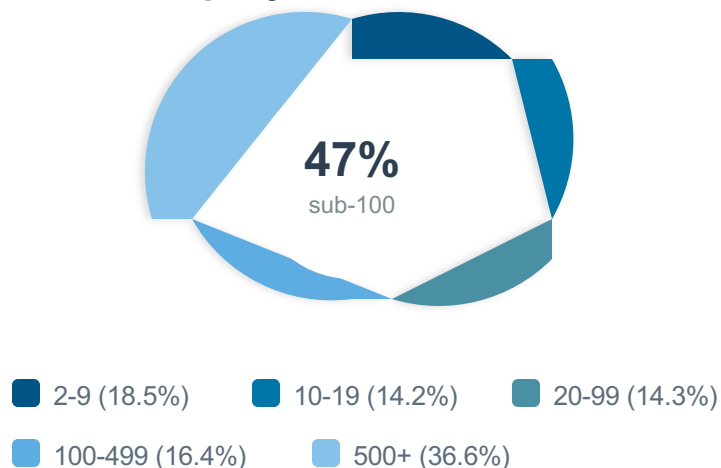
Niche functional languages (Erlang ~\$97K, Clojure ~\$95K) outearn mainstream stacks (JavaScript ~\$64K, PHP ~\$49K) by 50%+.



KEY INSIGHT

62% influence tech purchases; 60% prefer build-and-buy; 75% start with free trials. Developers are enterprise buyers.

Company Size Distribution



Developer Purchasing Power

62%

Influence tech purchases

60%

Prefer build-and-buy

75%

Start with free trial

73%

Ask other developers

- Developers are not just users — they are enterprise buyers with real budget influence

1. HYBRID-FIRST IS THE NEW DEFAULT

42% of developers work in hybrid mode; 38% remote. In-person is growing (20%) but not displacing distributed work. Design for hybrid.

2. NICHE SKILLS COMMAND PREMIUMS

Erlang (~\$97K), Clojure (~\$95K), and Elixir (~\$93K) outearn mainstream stacks by 50%+. Specialization pays — scarcity drives value.

3. U.S. FULL-TIME IS SOFTENING

U.S. full-time employment fell from 69% to 64.8% YoY. Freelancing holds at 16.4%. Expect more contractor and fractional roles.

4. DEVELOPERS ARE ENTERPRISE BUYERS

62% influence tech purchases; 75% start with free trials. Developer experience (DX) is a go-to-market strategy, not just engineering.

5. COMPENSATION FLATTENS AFTER 15 YEARS

Salary growth is steep from 0-10 years, then plateaus. Senior roles show widest dispersion. Retention strategies for 10+ year veterans must emphasize scope, autonomy, and equity over base salary.